



1 ◀ This portrait is built up on a small primed panel so that the paint can be scraped easily to give a more textural study. Make a quick sketch first with thinned paint if you need to work out correct proportions. Then smooth paint over the main areas of the portrait with light strokes.

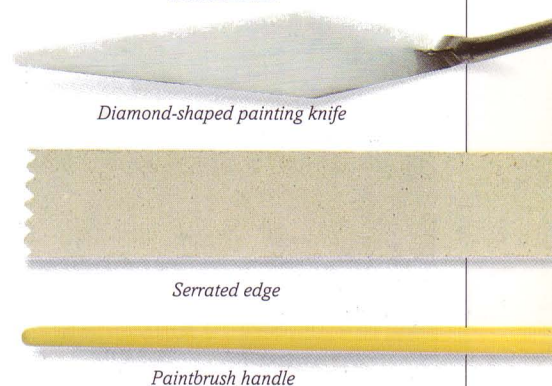


2 ◀ When you have applied different tones to the face and hair, use the edge of the painting knife, or a bit of cardboard with serrated edges, to emphasize the direction the hair grows in. These create highlights on the hair and help to break up heavy layers of paint.

3 ▶ Smooth a clean finger gently over any area where you need to blend the paint; a painting knife is effective for crisp lines of color, but it may be difficult to achieve the same degree of subtle blending that can be produced with a brush or a finger.



Materials



Diamond-shaped painting knife

Serrated edge

Paintbrush handle



4 ◀ Use the end of the painting knife, or the tip of a brush handle, if you want to make small dots of color and build up the texture of the painting. Dip the brush handle in paint and use it to suggest the pattern of this cardigan.

Textural portrait

A variety of expressive textural marks give this portrait life. A painting knife is used to apply the paint quickly and produce crisp strokes of color to establish the main features of the face. Additional techniques, such as lines and highlights made with a serrated edge and dabs of paint made with a brush handle, add to the textural surface. The painting knife has been used finally to apply thick impasted highlights.

Ridges of color

made with a painting knife catch the light to give the painting a brighter quality.

Paint is both smeared over the support and laid on with strokes of thick, impasted color.

The texture of the paint gives the work an almost three-dimensional look.



Christian Furr